Some in the Bank disdain communication. 'Why not let our achievements speak for themselves?' they might say. Unfortunately, in this world where the press is more attentive and the public more hungry for news, we either should shape news or we will be shaped by it. The latter is infinitely more unpleasant – some may recall the way we were termed anti-technology for some actions we took against a taxi company.

FLEXIBILITY

Successful organizations are usually vibrant and flexible. They adapt to circumstances. As we confront the challenges ahead, we need to be flexible. At one level, this means seizing opportunities that are thrown up by the expanding Indian economy. For example, the new function of gathering market intelligence, which feeds into State-level Coordination Committees, was a dynamic response to our inability to regulate all the operators who attempted to take advantage of regulatory vacuums. Going forward, we need to create regulatory capacity to monitor new entities like the internet market places that are also getting into lending.

While we should be wary of regulatory overreach, we must also recognize that if we do not expand our responsibilities, others will fill them. That is not always a bad thing, but if new regulators lead to a Balkanization of regulation and many regulatory gaps, the system will be worse off. So let us be prepared to step up where necessary instead of assuming others will take responsibility.

But this also means we should be prepared to hire new capabilities into the organization. While we will look for home grown talent where possible, we need lateral entry in some areas. We will minimize these areas, but if we are as good as we think we are, we should be prepared to see some lateral entry wherever necessary – provided internal people have a fair chance to compete for the jobs. This is one